AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

ID: _____

Name: _____

Faculty of Business Studies

LB170: Communication skills for business and management

FINAL EXAMINATION -Version B

Fall Semester 2025- 2026

14 – January – 2026

Number of Exam Pages: 7 (including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed: 3 hours**

PLEASE READ THE FOLLOWING INSTRUCTIONS

- This examination is composed of two parts. All questions are compulsory; you have to answer all questions.
- All the exam sections have to be answered on this exam paper.
- When you have finished, revise your answers in terms of content, language, and organization.
- Keep in mind that any form of cheating will not be tolerated and will subject you to AOU Cheating Policy.

Section	Allocated Marks for this question	EARNED Marks	Signature
Part I: Question A	10		
Part I: Question B	30		
Part II: Question A	30		
Part II: Question B	30		
TOTAL	100		

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This examination is composed of two parts. Answer all questions.

PART I (40 Marks)

a. **Read the sentences below and decide the function of each sentence by specifying which states a Hedging and which states a Boosting claim. Fill in your answers in the blank boxes. (10 Marks)**

Sentence	Function
1. Online education offers a solution to providing accessible, affordable learning opportunities in remote areas.	
2. Because of internet connectivity issues, live lectures are often recorded and shared later, while real-time interactive sessions are mostly reserved for students with stable high-speed access.	
3. Although further research is needed, we suspect that the flexibility of online classes (i.e., allowing students to study at their own pace) may have contributed to the higher completion rates.	
4. We suggest that interactive online tools are particularly useful for teaching complex subjects where student engagement is critical.	
5. One obvious implication of the rapid growth of online learning is that educational institutions will need to invest more in digital infrastructure and technical support.	

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b. In any organization, people need to communicate to achieve business objectives and to create a healthy and constructive working environment but the behavior and the language of the participants at a meeting can contribute to its failure or success. Complete the table with the reasons why meetings may fail and mention four strategies done by the chairperson before or during the meeting which might lead to its success. (30 Marks)

Why meetings may fail:	Strategies to be done by the chairperson:
1.	1. .....
2.	2. .....
3.	3. .....
4.	4. .....
5.	
6.	

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PART II (60 marks)

a. **Carefully read the problem text below and complete the following proposal sections. (30 Marks)**

- **Four proposed solutions.**
- **Four benefits of the proposed solutions.**
- **Two risks.**

Elegant Style Fashion House (ESFH)

After its establishment in 1995, the Elegant Style Fashion House (ESFH) expanded significantly and experienced steady growth in profits until 2020, when sales peaked at £25,000 per week. However, in recent years, the company has faced several challenges. Staff dissatisfaction has grown, leading to a number of resignations. Furthermore, a new competitor offering trendy designs at lower prices has opened nearby. These developments have likely contributed to the decline in sales, which dropped to £18,000 per week by 2023. Although ESFH has grown substantially since its foundation, it still operates under the informal management structure typical of a small boutique, which is no longer suitable. As a result, job roles and responsibilities are poorly defined, and the chain of command remains unclear. For example, employees often do not know who to consult when issues arise, which has led to duplicate orders of the same clothing collections. More critically, managers are overwhelmed with their individual tasks and fail to communicate effectively with each other or with staff. This communication breakdown has caused them to overlook the dissatisfaction and low morale spreading among employees.

Recently, five full-time staff members have resigned, and training new hires has proven costly and time-consuming. Management believes these staffing issues have played a significant role in the decline of sales. However, a deeper problem appears to be the unfair pay and commission system. Several employees have complained that only the sales supervisor receives a commission, while sales assistants, who directly serve customers and drive sales, do not benefit. Moreover, multiple responsibilities such as inventory management, pricing, visual merchandising, and customer service are assigned to the same group of employees without sufficient training. This results in frequent task overlaps and repeated mistakes, further contributing to frustration and a lack of cooperation among staff.

- ***Proposed solutions:***

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- **Benefits of proposed Solutions:**

- **Risks:**

Not Signed

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In a well written essay of around 300 words, answer the following question

b. **Team working is one of the core skills for employability. According to Schein (1980), teams form for both functional and psychological reasons. Write an essay discussing the functional and psychological reasons according to Schein theory. (30 Marks)**

Abu Bakr

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